

Web Design

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- I'm Klaus
- ~ 15 years of developing 
- MTD 11 & IM 14
- “Headless Web Development” course in KWM 2024
- working at Netural as web developer

Intro

Why I ❤️ it

- web as a toolbox
- show & tell
- express yourself
- endless possibilities

What do you expect from the course?



slido.com

#3937946

Why is a
web developer
telling stories about
web design?

Understanding
leads to
excellent results

The Goals

**Spark
creativity**

**Design your
portfolio**

- Learn design principles 
- Explore and apply in Figma
- Create portfolio design & prototype
- Successfully handover Design to Dev

The Course

Mode & Grading

- 2 ECTS
- 6 Sessions of Lecture + Lab
- Grading
 - Grading scheme
 - Project hand-ins (single-person projects)
 - Presentation

MI, 08.10.

MI, 22.10. (23.10.) Homework

DO, 06.11. Homework

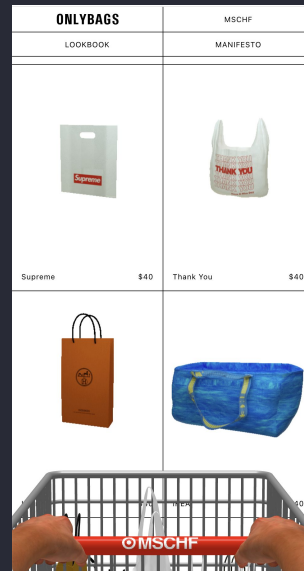
MI, 19.11.

MI, 03.12. (04.12.) Homework

MI, 10.12. Presentations

Introduction to web design

- What is web design? Scope, disciplines, real-world examples
- Designer vs. Developer: collaboration, expectations
- Web vs. Print design
- Visual hierarchy, usability
- Introduction to Figma: Interface, projects, frames, “present” view
- Inspirational resources - discover, <https://uizard.io/>



onlybags.biz

Typography and Color

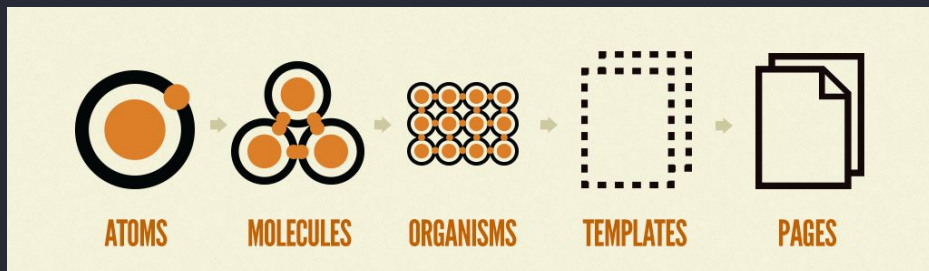
- Typography systems and web fonts
- Typography groups (sans, serif, display)
- Font-sizes and scaling
- Readability, line height, font pairing
- Color theory, contrast, and accessibility (WCAG basics - contrast, sizing)
- Google Fonts and tools for color selection
- Typography with color and images



typescale.com

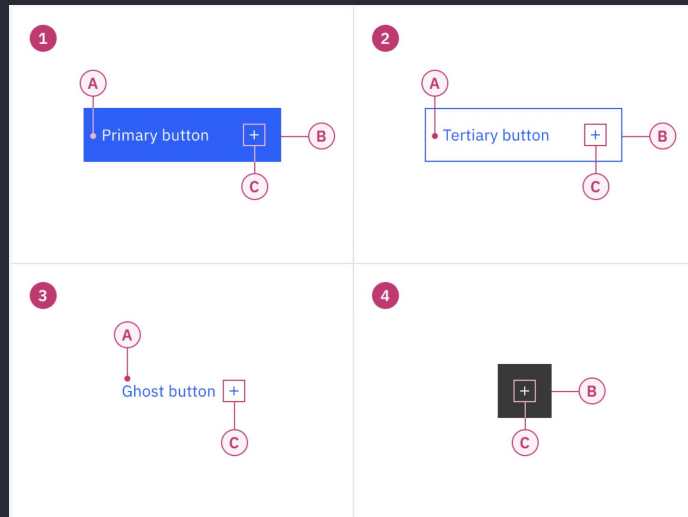
Layout, Grid and Responsiveness

- Atomic Design (and similar approaches)
- Grids, spacing, alignment
- Responsive design principles
- Breakpoints and fluid layouts
- Auto Layout in Figma



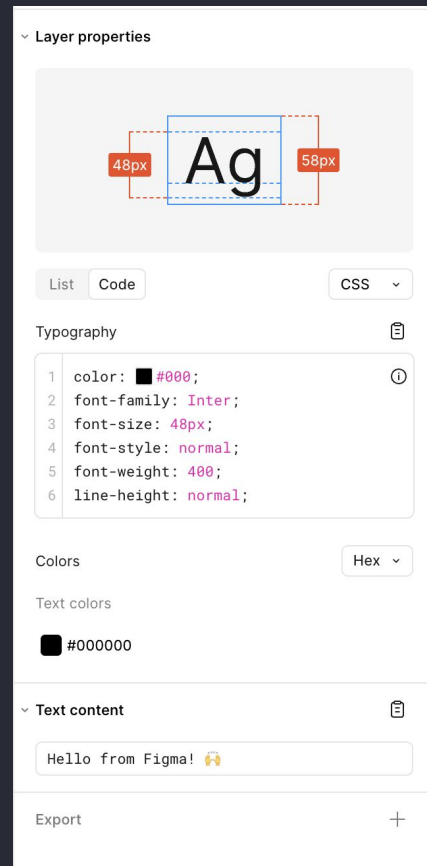
Components, Icons and Images

- Components, variants, reusability in design
- Component vs. instance
- Best practices for images and SVGs
- Using component / icon libraries
- Preparing assets for development
- Accessibility overview



Handoff to Development

- What developers need: specs, spacing, fonts, assets
- Figma DEV mode, CSS values, redlines
- Design tokens overview
- Tools: Figma Dev Mode, Figma Comments, Zeplin
- Share prototype
- Add uniqueness to your design, make it personal



Review and final presentations

- Recap of core design principles
- What did you enjoy most?
- Common mistakes & how to avoid them
- Tips for working with developers
- Final presentations 🥳



What is web design?

What are your favorite websites?



slido.com

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What are your favorite websites? – Answers

pixabay.com

[Volvo](https://www.volvocars.com)

[pinterest](https://www.pinterest.com)

[ecosia](https://www.ecosia.org)

[discord](https://discord.com)

[youtube](https://www.youtube.com)

[RGG Studio Sega](https://www.rgg-studio.se)

[MyAnimelist](https://www.myanimelist.net)

[streamcloud](https://www.streamcloud.net)

[AO3](https://www.ao3.org)

[TikTok](https://www.tiktok.com)

<https://www.bibliothek-david-steindl-rast.ch/>

[Discord](https://discord.com)

[Pinterest](https://www.pinterest.com)

[Thestoryshack](https://www.thestoryshack.com)

[Persona 5 website](https://www.persona5.com)

[willhaben](https://www.willhaben.de)

[Nonstop kino](https://www.nonstopkino.com)

[Pinterest](https://www.pinterest.com)

[Spotify](https://www.spotify.com)

[Kahoot!](https://www.kahoot.com)

[A10.com](https://www.a10.com)

[Behance](https://www.behance.net)

[FH Hagenberg E-Learning](https://www.fh-hagenberg.at)

[reddit](https://www.reddit.com)

[JetBrains Mono](https://www.jetbrains.com/idea/)

[Letterboxd](https://www.letterboxd.com)

<https://github.com>

[GitHub](https://github.com)

[A10.com](https://www.a10.com)

[Coolers.co](https://www.coolers.co)

[Rule34](https://www.rule34.xxx)

[Twitch](https://www.twitch.tv)

[Lodle](https://www.lodle.com)

[DaVinci Resolve](https://www.davinciresolve.com)

[https://guthib.com/](https://github.com)

[the useless website](https://www.theuselesswebsite.com)

[Google](https://www.google.com)

[Wikipedia](https://www.wikipedia.org)

<https://zenless.hoyoverse.com>

[YuniCon](https://www.yunicon.com)

[levis.fh-ooe.at/](https://www.levis.fh-ooe.at/)

[YouTube](https://www.youtube.com)

<https://dogstudio.co/>

[Youtube](https://www.youtube.com)

[https://www.thelifestudio.com /](https://www.thelifestudio.com/)

<https://www.forticheprod.com>

[behance](https://www.behance.net)

[pinterest](https://www.pinterest.com)

[Apple](https://www.apple.com)

[Porsche](https://www.porsche.com)

PEPSI WORLD

WHAT'S NEW

CHECK OUT
THE MICROSOFT
CONNECTION!

Full of magic
and surprise...
PEPSI HOLIDAY '96



APPLICATIONS
NEEDED

ENTER

WARNING: IF TRAVELING AT SPEEDS LESS
THAN 28.8 Kbps THEN JUMP ON THE LOW ROAD

LR

If you have the Shockwave plug-in - [CLICK HERE](#)



<https://www.spacejam.com/1996/>

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Download iTunes 1.1

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**Design is
diverse and everywhere**

So you wanna have a website?

Phases of a web project

- Idea / Goal
- Concept & Requirements
- Research, Wireframe & Prototype
- UI Design
- Handoff
- Development
- Feedback
- Launch

Phases of a web project – Key roles

- Idea / Goal
- Concept & Requirements
- Research, Wireframe & Prototype
- UI Design
- Handoff
- Development
- Feedback
- Launch
- Customers
- Users
- Designers
- Developers
- Quality Assurance
- Project Managers

Designers and developers

YOU SHALL NOT PASS.





Gandalf against the Balrog by Magali Villeneuve

Successful collaboration – expectations

- *“It has to be consistent”*
- *“Why is the spacing different here? I need an extra variable for that !!!111”*
- *“There was no design budget for that”*
- *“Give me a list of all colors and where they are used”*
- *“That button style doesn’t exist and it would take four days to implement it!”*
- *“Wow, that turned out so cool!”*

Successful collaboration – designers & developers

- Remember the goal
- Understand each other
- Listen, ask questions and find answers
- Set expectations
- Define a clear **handoff**
- Get a basic toolbox of **design core principles**

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Web vs. print design

三宅
一生

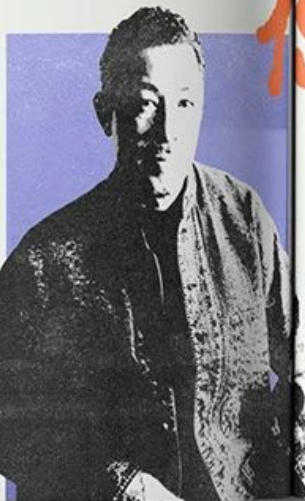
Issey Miyake is not merely a fashion designer; he is a revolutionary figure who reshaped the boundaries of clothing design by merging technology, philosophy, and aesthetics into a new language of modern wear. Born in Hiroshima, Japan, in 1938, Miyake's life and work were profoundly influenced by the intersection of tragedy, innovation, and cultural transformation.

After studying graphic design at Tama Art University in Tokyo, Miyake moved to Paris

in the 1960s and studied at the prestigious École de la Chambre Syndicale de la Couture Parisienne, working for renowned fashion houses such as Guy Laroche and Givenchy.

01

ISSEY MIYAKE
ISSEY MIYAKE
ISSEY MIYAKE



1938

it's
for
life.

Design is not for philosophy

These experiences gave him deep insight into the European haute couture system — a world he both respected and later challenged.

Miyake's design journey was shaped by a unique East-West perspective. While embracing modernist ideals, he retained deep respect for traditional Japanese craftsmanship and simplicity. His vision transcended borders and was informed by global sensibilities, not fashion trends.

Miyake was only seven years old when the atomic bomb was dropped on Hiroshima in 1945. Though he rarely spoke of it publicly, this early experience with destruction and resilience subtly infused his work with a reverence for life, rebirth, and endurance. His garments often express a quiet strength — soft yet structured, innovative yet timeless.

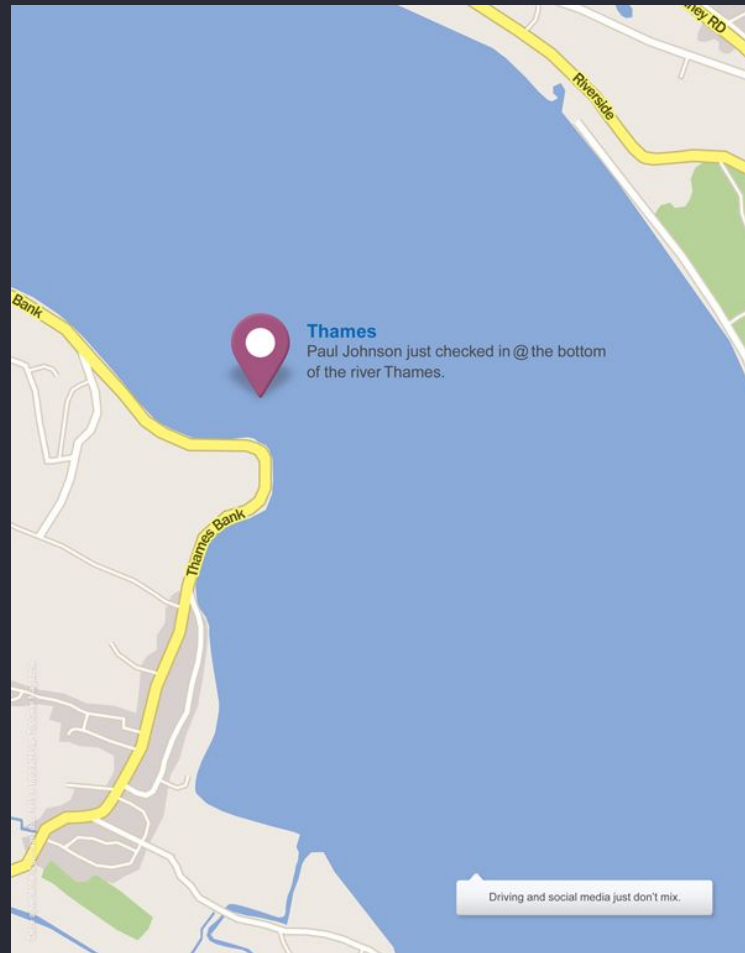
When asked whether he identified as a "fashion designer," Miyake often rejected the label.

He preferred to be seen as someone who "makes things." For him, fashion was not about glamour — it was about people, purpose, and potential. Miyake was only seven years old when the atomic bomb was dropped on Hiroshima in 1945. Though he rarely spoke of it publicly, this early experience with destruction and resilience subtly infused his work with a reverence for life,

rebirth, and endurance. His garments often express a quiet strength — soft yet structured, innovative yet timeless. The story of Issey Miyake begins not just with a man who designed clothing, but with a creative force who redefined the purpose of fashion.

02







THE LOBSTER

UNE HISTOIRE D'AMOUR DE **YORGOS LANTHIMOS**

[illegible]

THE LOBSTER

Director of photography THOMAS BAKSTADT **editor** YONGE WATSON **casting director** JING JIN **producer** LIP COLLINS **sound designer** JENNIFER BURN **production designer** JACQUELINE ABRAMS **costume designer** SARAH KLEINBERGER **hair designer** EILEEN KIM **makeup designer** SHARON OCHO **production office** CHRISTOPHER KONTANTAKOPOULOS / LEONIE PETT / CAROL SCOTT / JACQUE DE VRIES and DENI JANMANN **production office** KAREN WILSON / TESSA KIM and SAM LAMBERT **production** BOUTIQUE LES MAQUILLÉS / THE MAQUILLÉS and TONGUE TALKING



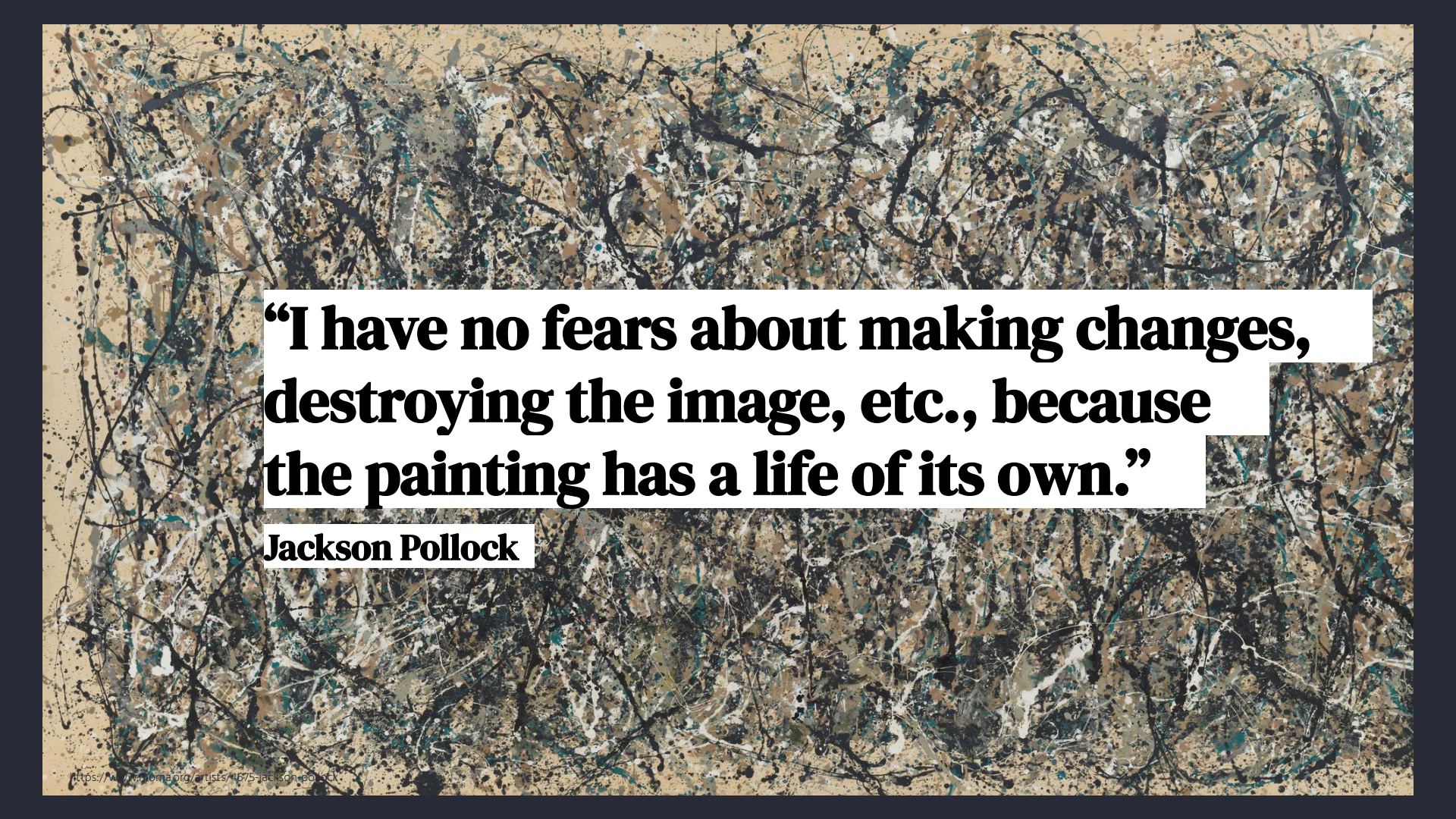






Apple iPod + iTunes



An abstract painting by Jackson Pollock, featuring a dense, chaotic composition of black, white, and blue lines and splatters on a light brown background. The lines are thin and expressive, creating a sense of movement and energy. The overall effect is one of spontaneity and improvisation.

**“I have no fears about making changes,
destroying the image, etc., because
the painting has a life of its own.”**

Jackson Pollock

Print has a canvas.

A magazine has a format.

A poster has a format.

A painting has a canvas.

Web

Print

Layout

dynamic

static

Interaction

bi-directional

uni-directional

Motion

vast

limited

User journey

physical, slow paced

digital, fast-paced

The digital canvas is **fluid** & **unlimited**

Responsive Design

design for a variety of screen sizes, users needs,
adapt to your environment

term coined by Ethan Marcotte, Jeffrey Zeldman and many many many others

DOLSTEN & CO.

WE MAKE AI

COME ALIVE

da



The Life of

David

INTRODUCING THE WINNER, DAVID ALABA! THIS FOOTBALL SUPERSTAR HAS ACCOMPLISHED MORE THAN MOST COULD EVER DREAM OF.

Alaba

<https://www.wardrobe.com/sites/david-alaba>

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- Inspirational resources - discover, <https://uizard.io/>

Visual hierarchy

**When everything is equal,
you don't know where to start first.**

Use visual hierarchy to guide the eye

that's why fine print exists.

Headline
Subheadline
Body Text
Logo

Headline

Subheadline

Body Text

Logo

Headline

Subheadline

Body Text

Logo

Why are designers using visual hierarchy?

Improves **readability** and **usability**

Directs focus to **key messages**

Creates a **logical flow** for information

Reduces **cognitive load** for the viewer

Key principles of visual hierarchy



Size & Scale

Bigger elements
draw attention first.



Color & contrast

Bright/bold colors stand out.



Position & alignment

Eye moves top → bottom,
left → right (often)



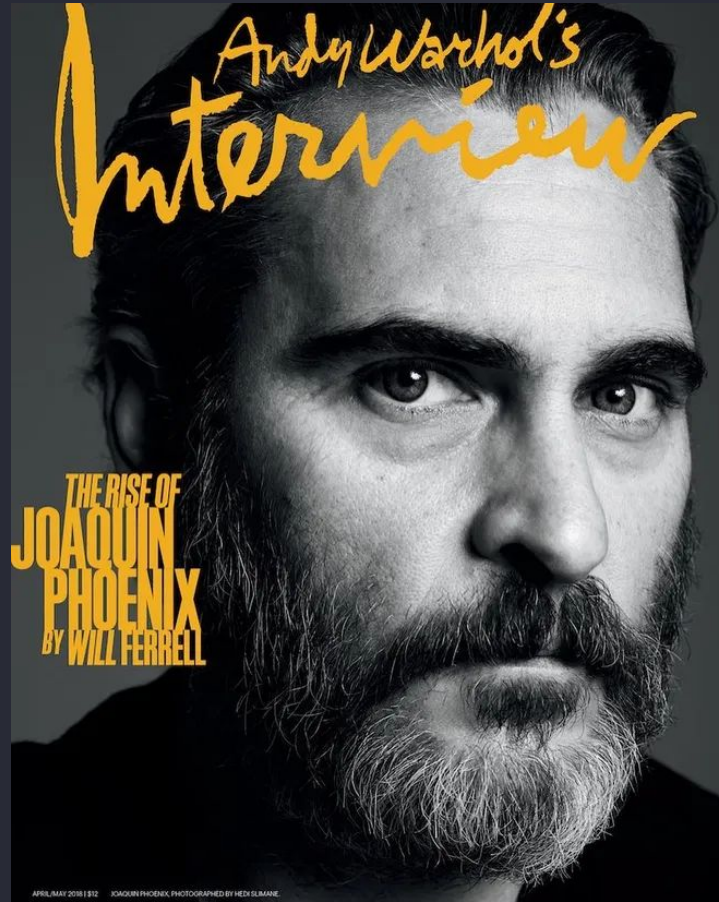
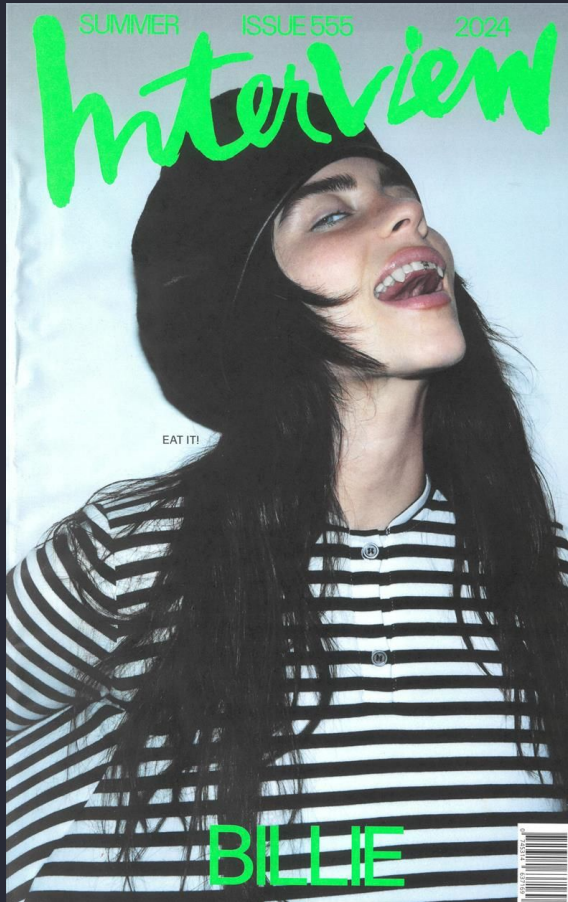
Typography

Headlines vs. subtext styles



Spacing & grouping

White space creates emphasis
and separation.







ABOUT

ABOUT

ABOUT

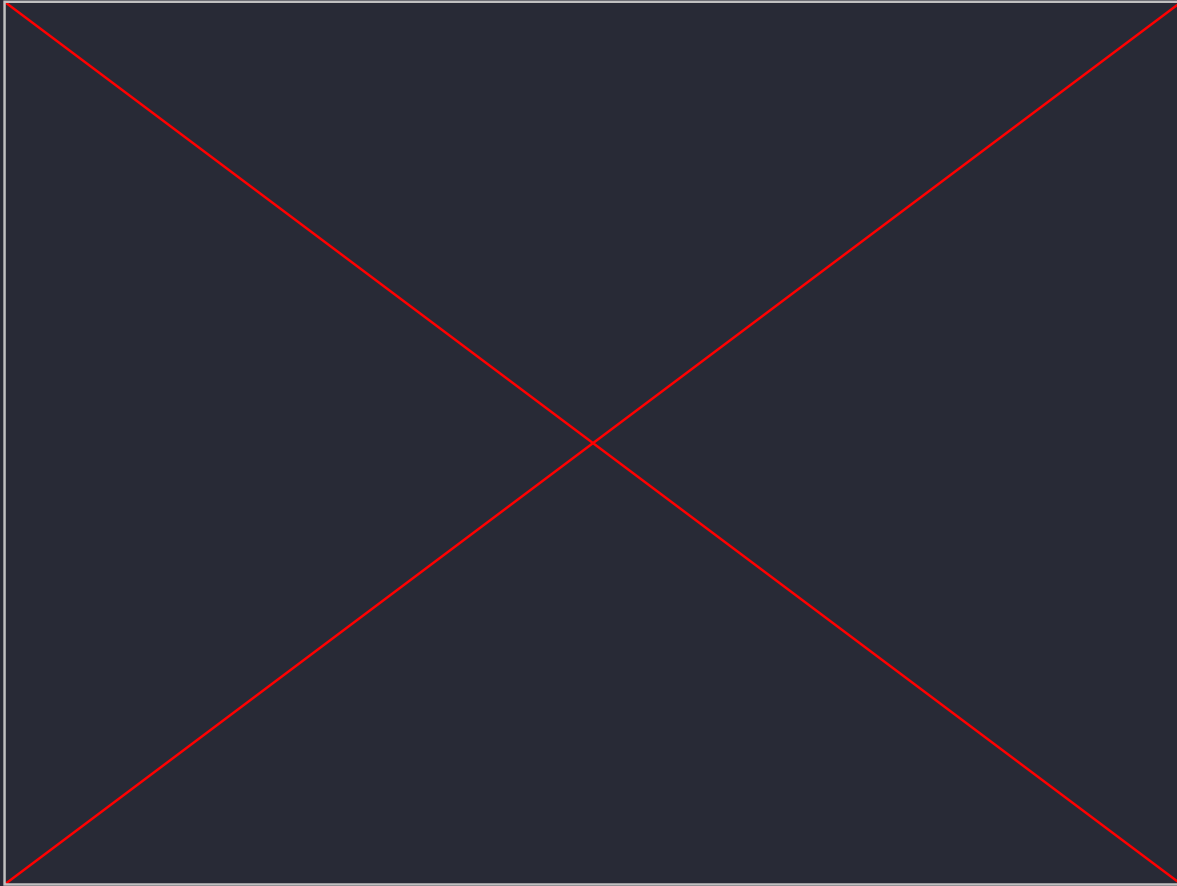
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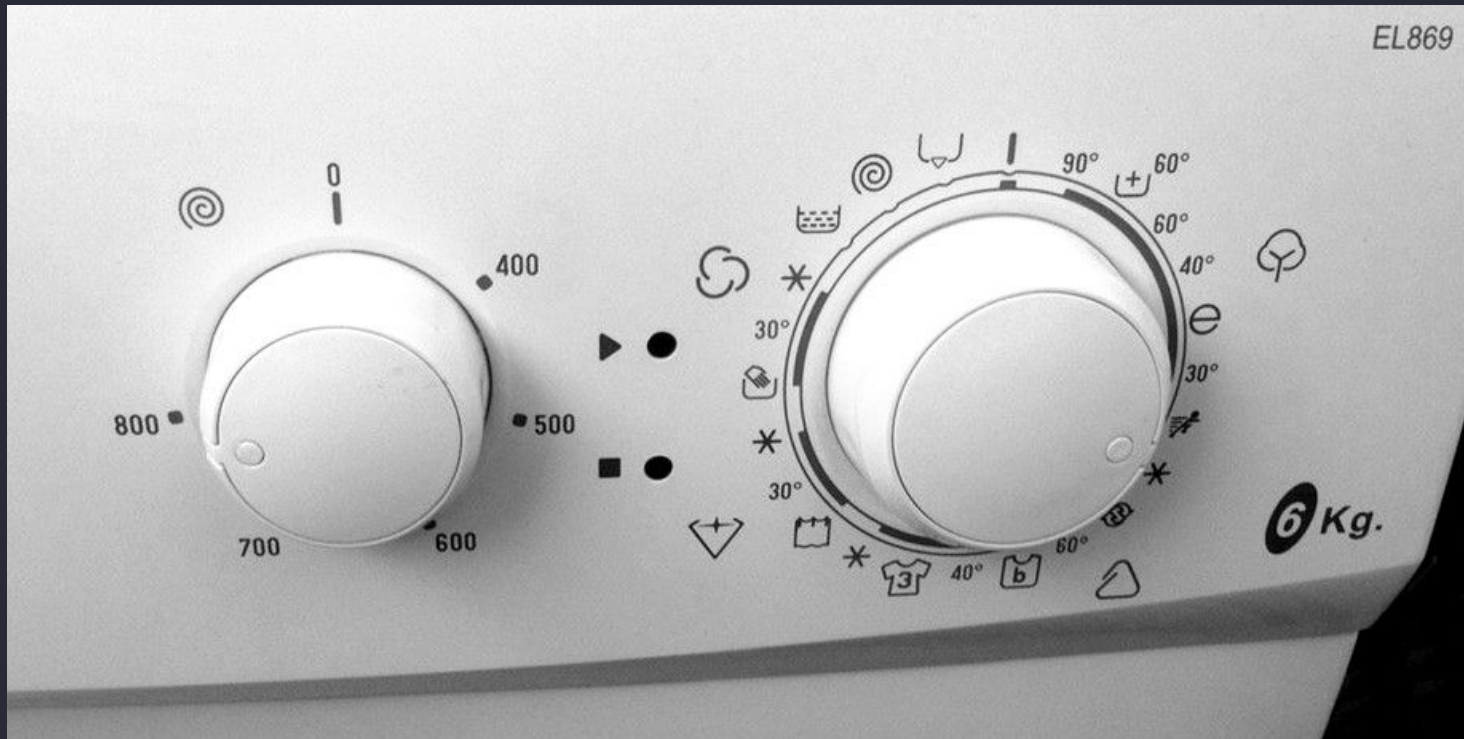
one of the most storied names in the music industry, traces its origins to the dawn of recorded sound and has played a pivotal role in shaping the soundtracks of generations. From the invention of the 45 rpm single to launching the careers of music icons, RCA's journey is intertwined with the history of music itself.

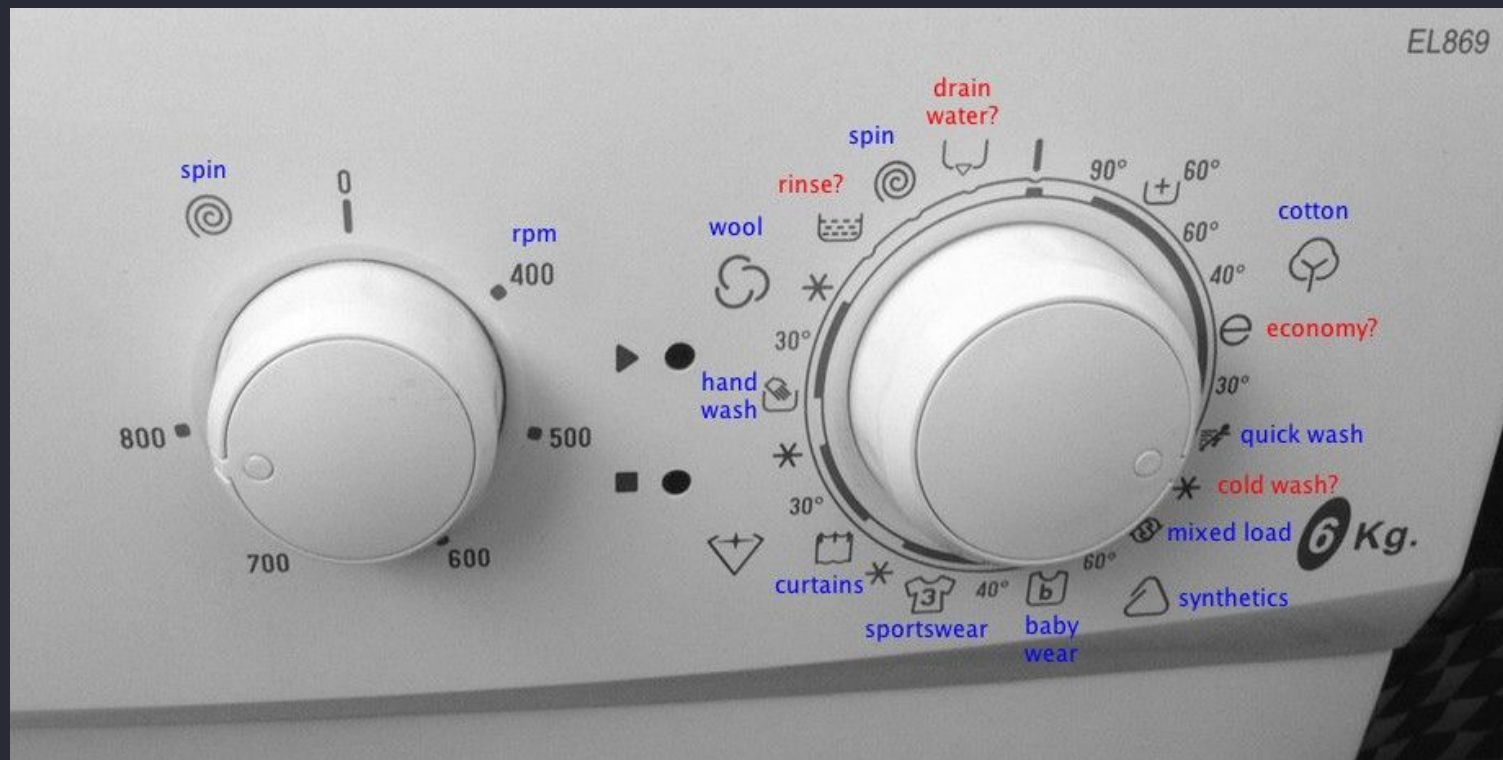


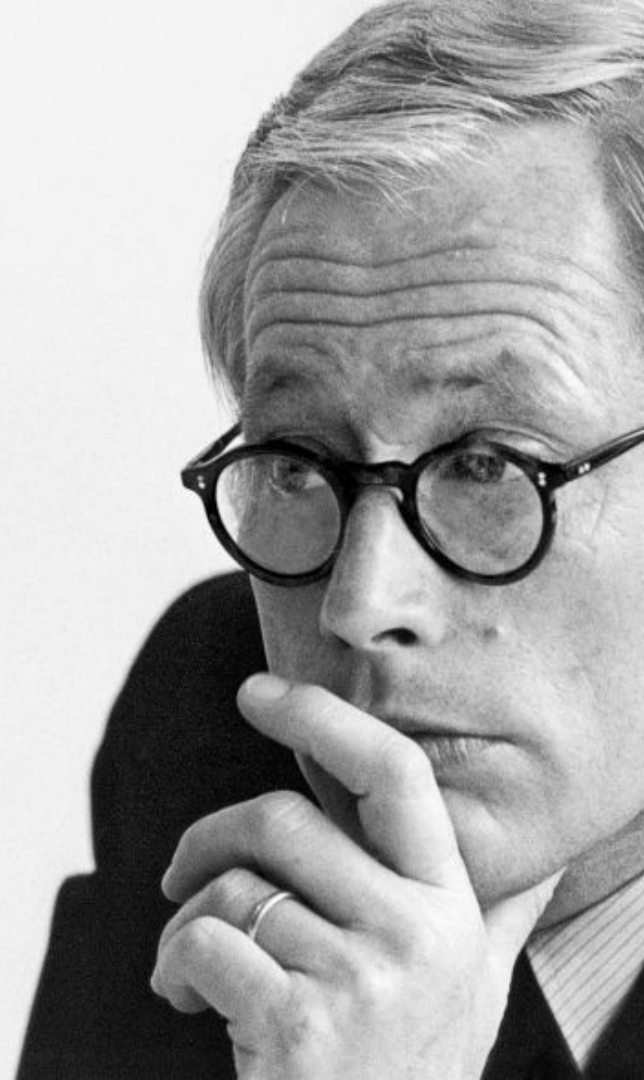
Visual hierarchy



Usability



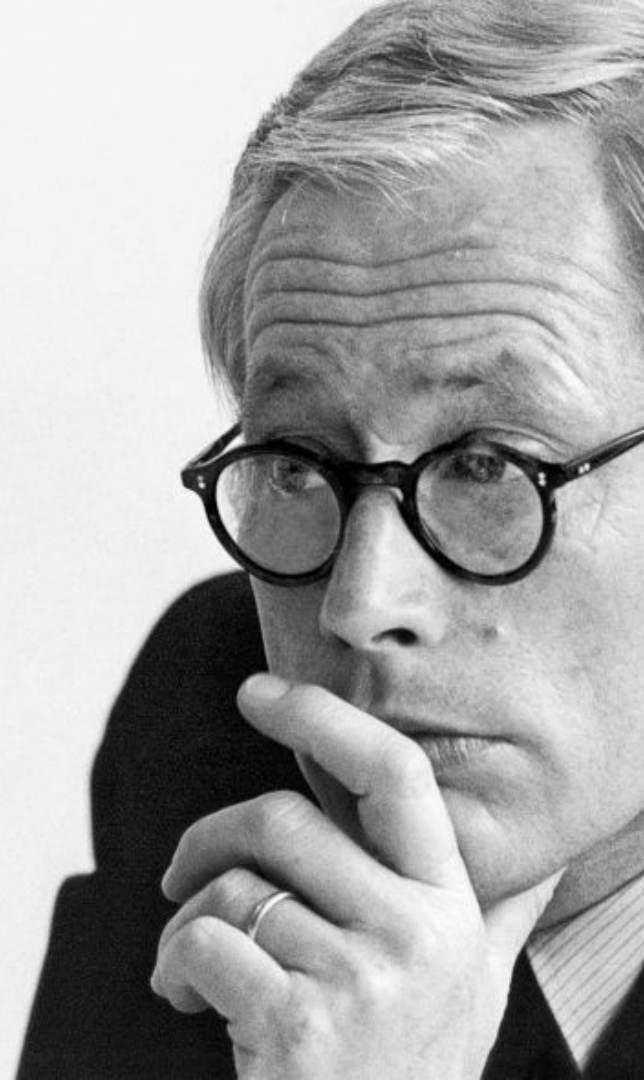




Good design is as little design as possible

Dieter Rams

<https://www.vitsoe.com/us/about/good-design#ten-principles-for-good-design>



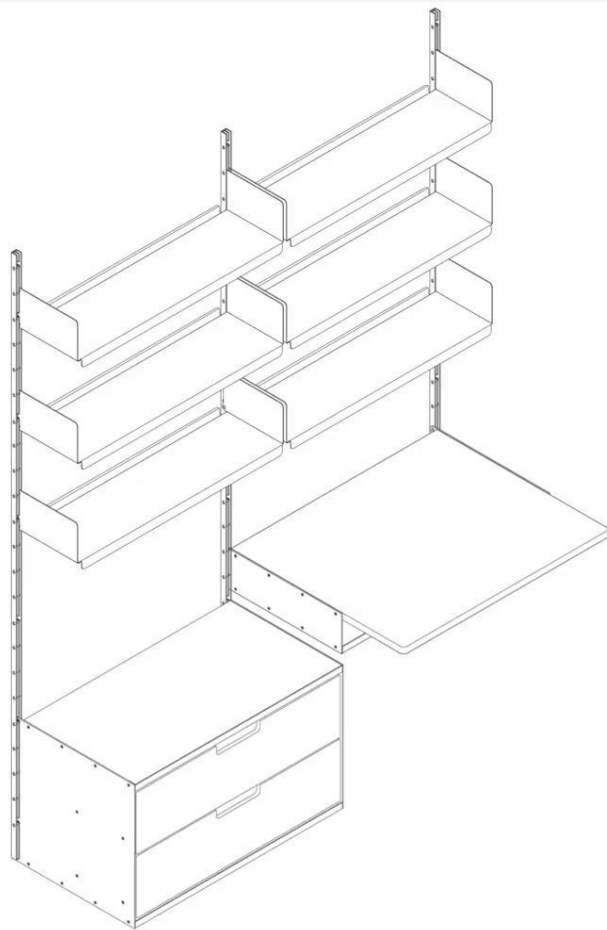


RT 20 Tabletop radio – Dieter Rams for Braun, 1961



606 Shelving system – Dieter Rams for Vitsoe, 1960

<https://www.vitsoe.com/us/about/good-design#ten-principles-for-good-design>



THE LAWS OF SIMPLICITY

DESIGN, TECHNOLOGY, BUSINESS, LIFE

John Maeda



LAW 1 / REDUCE

The simplest way to achieve simplicity is through thoughtful reduction.



LAW 2 / ORGANIZE

Organization makes a system of many appear fewer.



LAW 3 / TIME

Savings in time feel like simplicity.



LAW 4 / LEARN

Knowledge makes everything simpler.



LAW 5 / DIFFERENCES

Simplicity and complexity need each other.



LAW 6 / CONTEXT

What lies in the periphery of simplicity is definitely not peripheral.



LAW 7 / EMOTION

More emotions are better than less.



LAW 8 / TRUST

In simplicity we trust.



LAW 9 / FAILURE

Some things can never be made simple.



LAW 10 / THE ONE

Simplicity is about subtracting the obvious, and adding the meaningful.



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- Inspirational resources - discover

Introduction to Figma

Why Figma and not XYZ?

- If you know how to ride a bike, the brand doesn't matter.

1990

Adobe Photoshop

raster graphics

use many years for web designs

local

2010

Sketch

vector graphics

more web focused

local

2016

Figma

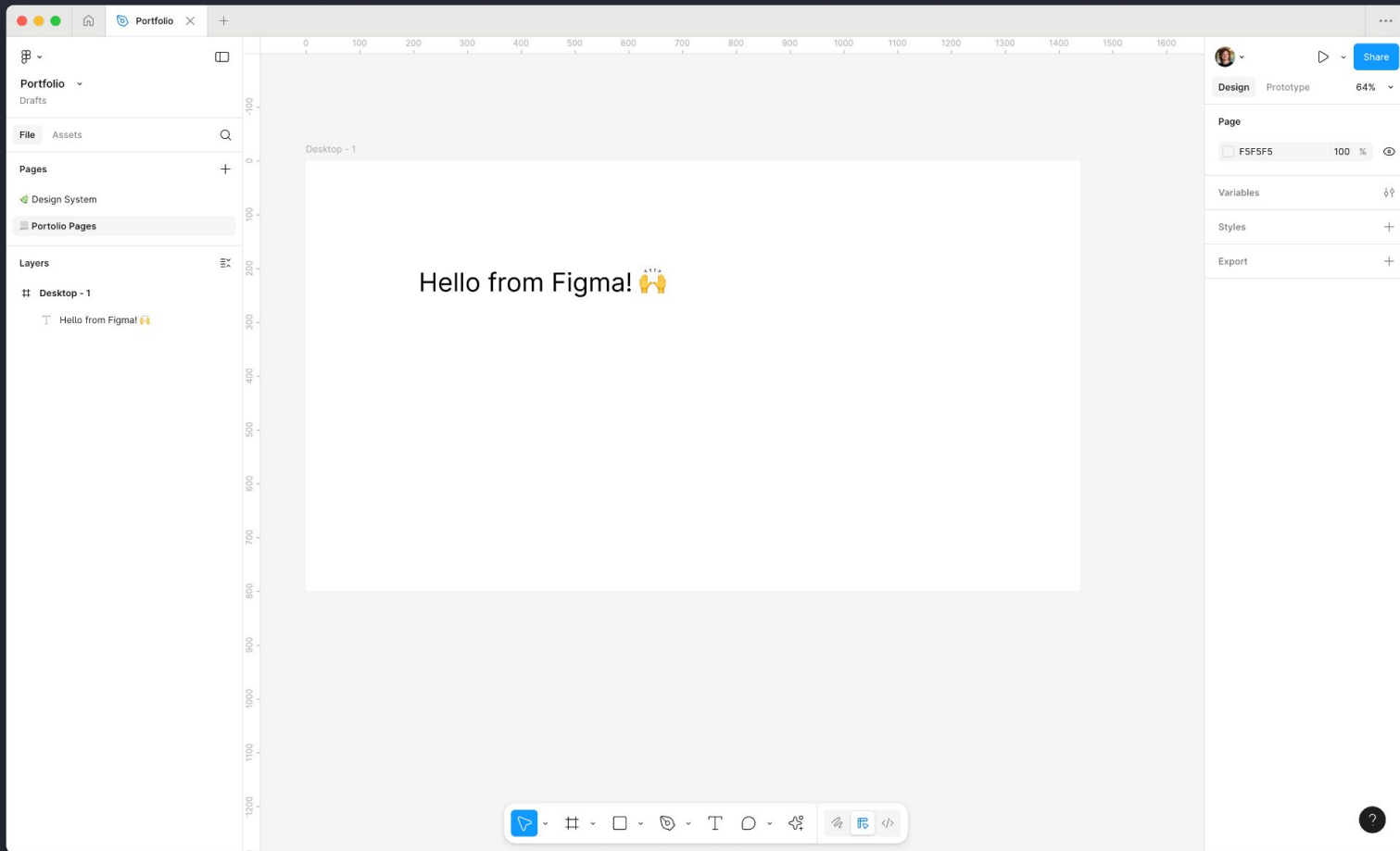
vector graphics

“multiplayer mode”

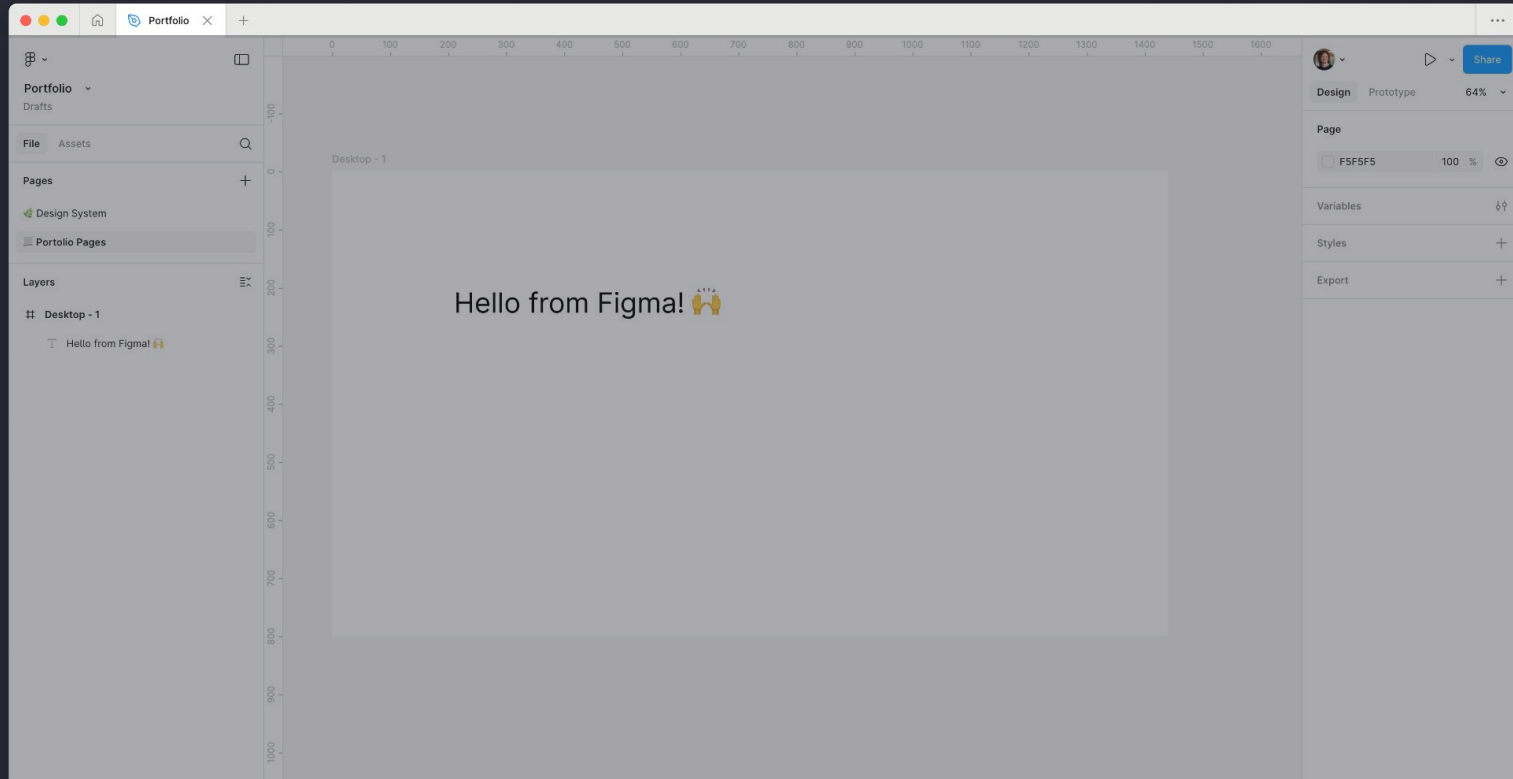
cloud

Why Figma and not XYZ?

- Vector based
- Multiplayer mode enables parallel collab on same design
 - game changer 🤖 no more MyDesign_final_v2.psd
- Comment feedback directly inside Figma
- Auto-Layout (Responsive Web Design)
- Design System / component-oriented
- Prototypes (Click-Dummy)



Switch between projects



Multiple “pages” in one project

Each “page” can have multiple “layers”

“layers” are often times frames / sections

Page

Frame

Frame

Section

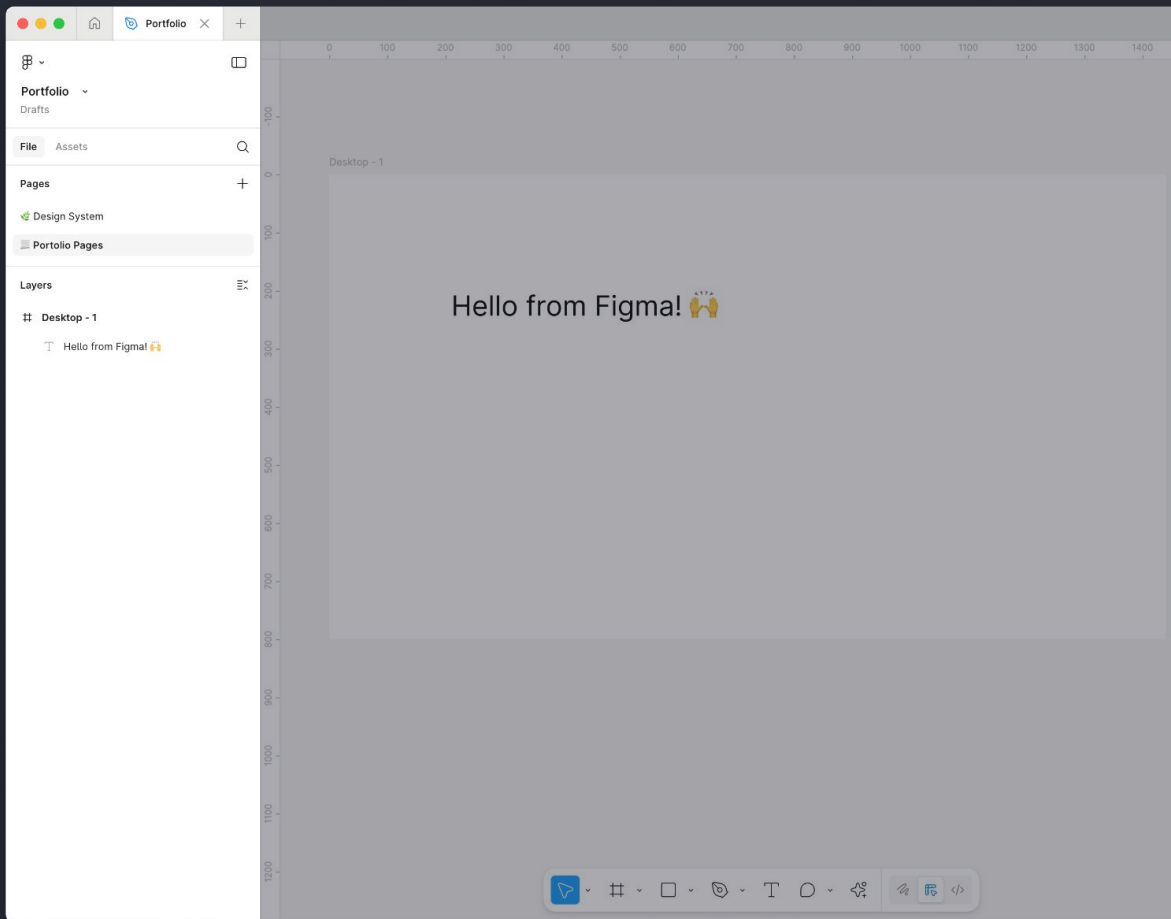
Frame

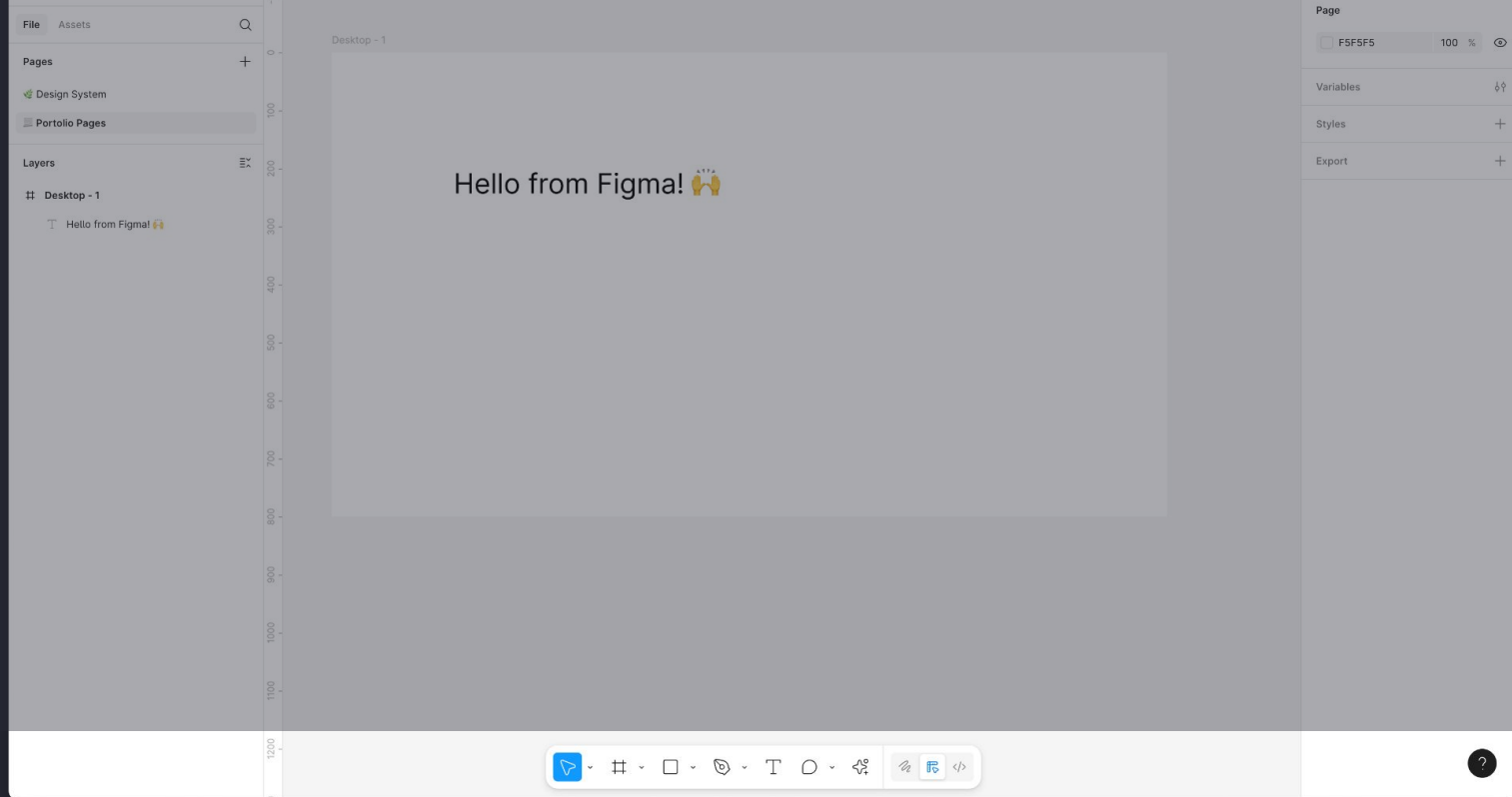
Frame

Page

Frame

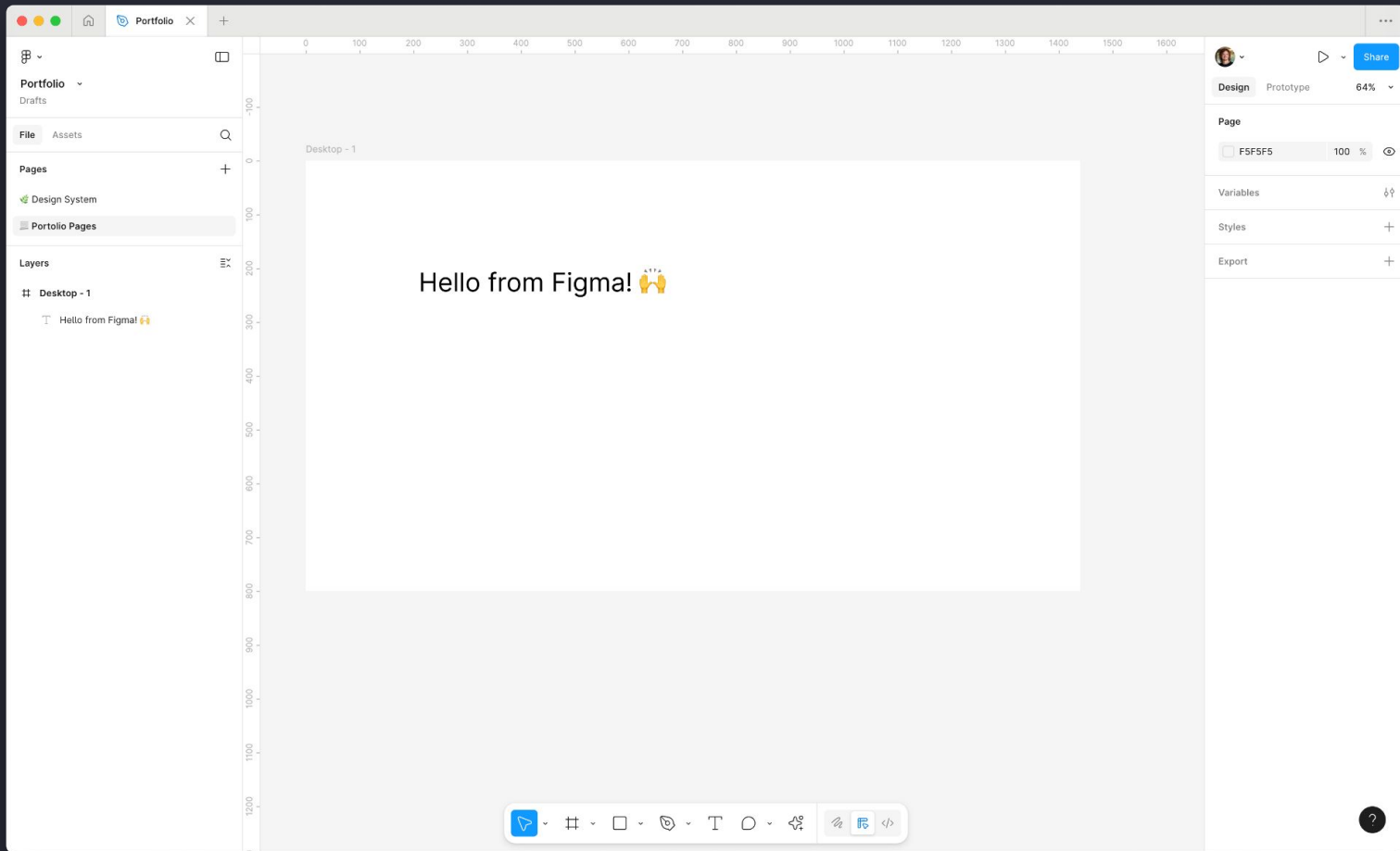
Frame

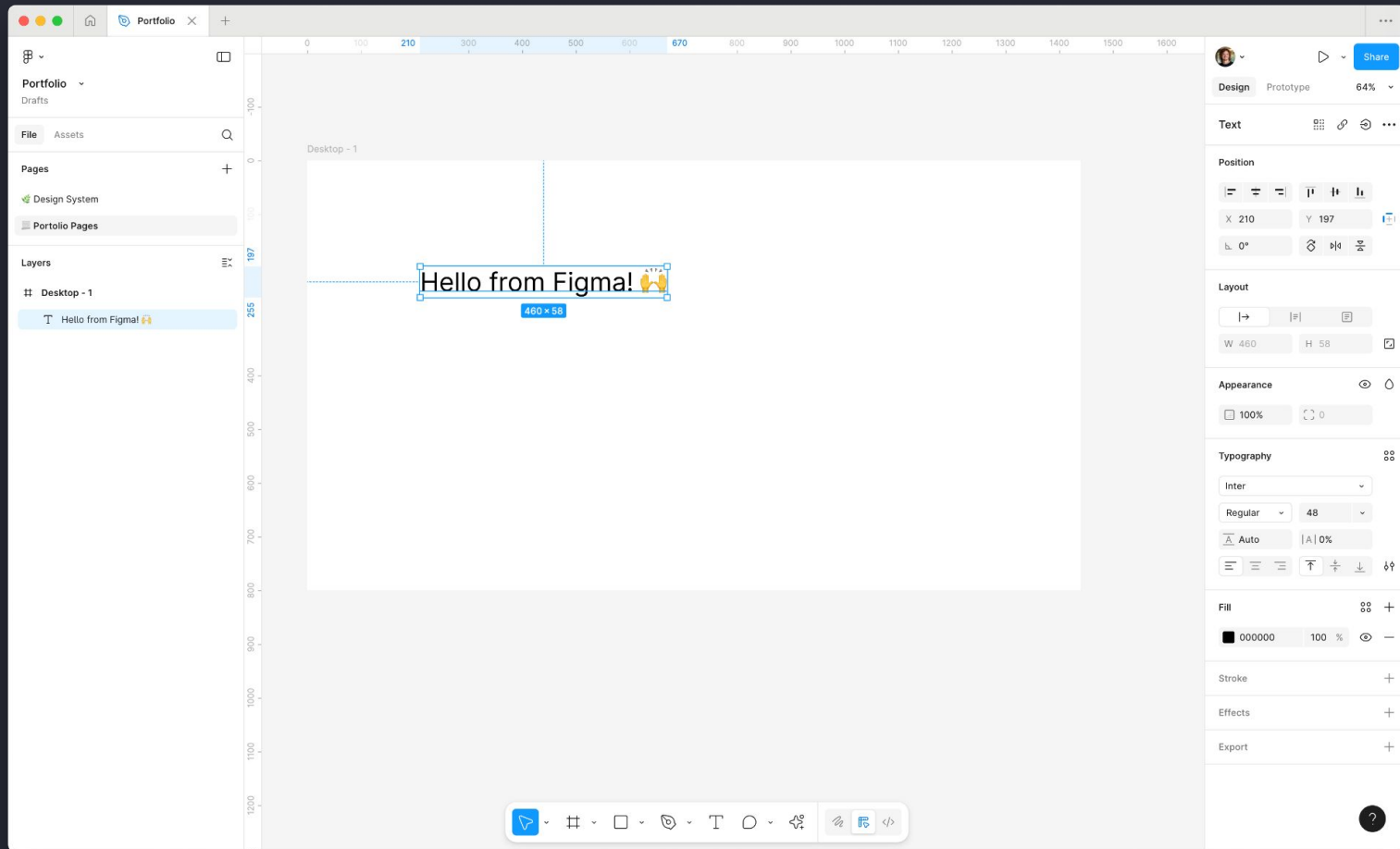


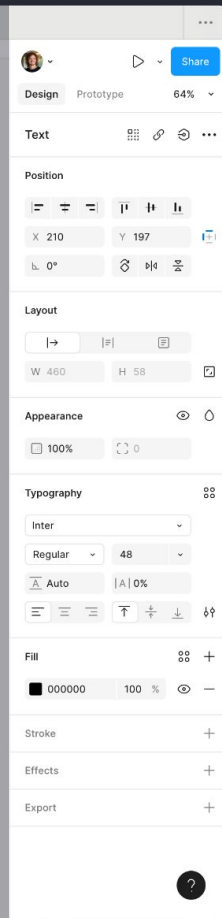
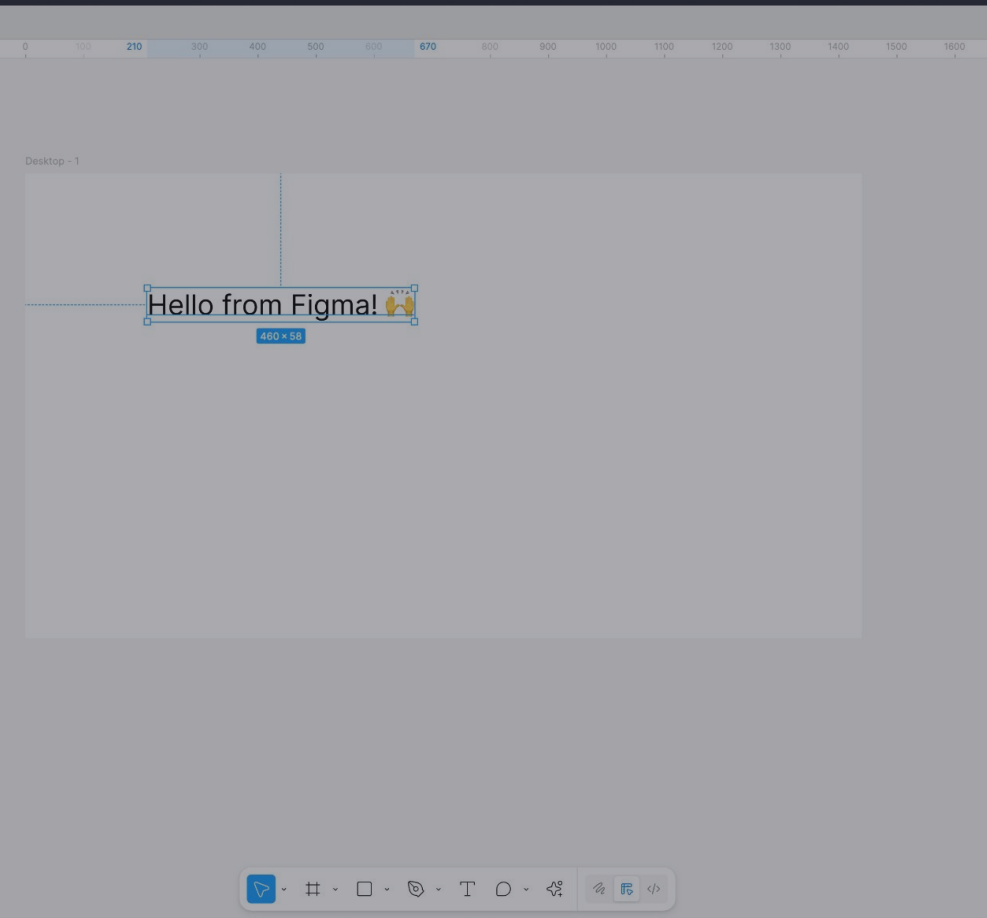


Create new objects

Switch between "Draw", "Design" and "Dev" mode







Edit current object

Position & Layout

Effects (Opacity / Blur)

Typography

Color

Export

Where do you expect to struggle?



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Where do you expect to struggle?



Summary

- Set and remember a **goal**, a key message
- Be patient about the process
- Use key principles of **visual hierarchy**
- Good design is as little design as possible
- Get inspired

Summary

- Set and remember a **goal**, a key message
- Be patient about the process
- Use key principles of **visual hierarchy**
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Practice Session

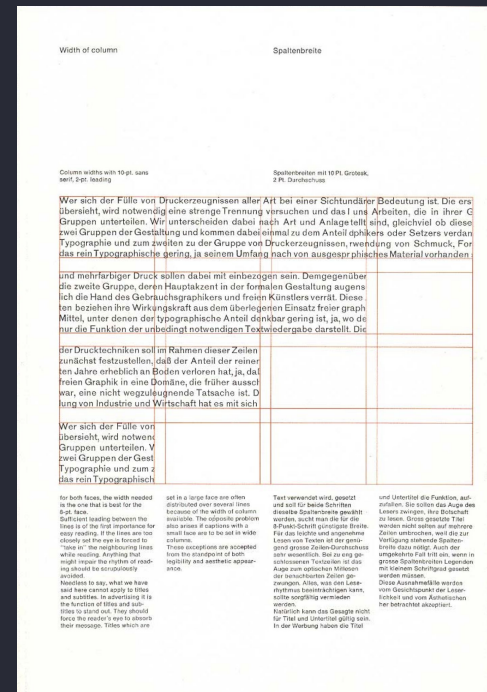
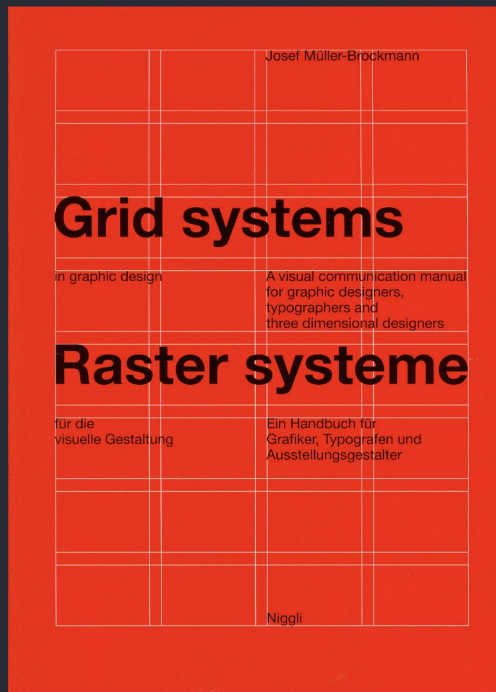
- Intro to Figma
- UI Overview
- Basic Shapes & Text
- Wireframe your portfolio website
- Shortcuts
- Q&A

Inspiration

- <https://abduzeedo.com>
- <https://www.awwwards.com>
- <https://thefwa.com>
- <https://www.cssdesignawards.com>
- <https://fontsinuse.com>
- <https://loadmo.re>
- Pinterest / Instagram / Behance

Inspiration

- Look at non-web-stuff: architecture, biology, typography, posters, album covers, ...
- Josef Müller-Brockmann: Grid Systems



Inspiration

- smashingmagazine.com
- alistapart.com
- uizard.io

Thanks!

